



The Bridesmaid La Demoiselle d'honneur

Un film de: Claude Chabrol

©/Co-production Company/Presented by: Aliceléo

©/Co-production Company: France 2 Cinéma,

Canal Diffusion, Integral Film GmbH

In association with: Cofimage 15

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FFA - Filmförderungsanstalt

With the participation of: BAC Films

International Sales: StudioCanal

Executive Producer: Françoise Galfré

Supervising Producer: Patrick Godeau

Produced by: Patrick Godeau, Antonio Passalia,

Alfred Hürmer

Unit Production Manager: Thierry Magniez

Unit Production Manager (German Shoot):

Laura Einmahl

Production Manager: Michel Jullien

Production Manager (German Shoot):

Anne Lessnick

Location Manager: Catherine Pierrat

Location Manager (German Shoot): Claude Garnier,

Helmut Glassmann

Unit Manager (German Short): Carolin von Fritsch

1st Assistant Director: Cécile Maistre

2nd Assistant Director: Vincent Guillerminet

3rd Assistant Director: Eymeric Ioualalen

Script Supervisor: Aurore Chabrol

Scenario/Adaptation/Dialogue: Pierre Leccia,

Claude Chabrol

Based on the book by: Ruth Rendell

Director of Photography: Eduardo Serra

Camera Operator: Michel Thiriet

Steadicam Operator: Mathieu Caudroy

Focus Puller: David Grinberg

Clapper Loader: Delphine Desbruères

Gaffers: Michel Atanassian, Claude Atanassian

Stills Photography: Moune Jamet

Editor: Monique Fardoulis

Additional Editors: Olivier Rossignol,

Stanislas Moreau

Art Director: Françoise Benoît-Fresco

Set Decorator: Anne Bourleyre

Sculptures: Aleth Galen

Set Property Master: Pierre Galliard

Properties: Julien Grisot

Construction Manager: Jérôme Perrin

Costumes: Mic Cheminal

Costumer: Sandrine Kerner

Wardrobe: Laurence Glentzlin

Key Make-up: Françoise Andrejka

Make-up Artists: Stéphanie Gouzer,

Stéphanie Orillard

Make-up Artist (German Shoot): Tatjana Luckdorf

Key Special Make-up Effects:

Dominique Collandant

Key Hairstylist: Cédric Chami

Hairstylists: Antoine Mancini, Christine Borny

Titles: L'E.S.T.

Laboratory: GTC

Colour Timer: Christophe Bousquet

Music: Matthieu Chabrol

Orchestra Conducted by: Laurent Petitgirard

Sound Recording: Pierre Lenoir

Sound Re-recording: Thierry Lebon

Claude Chabrol: Elements of Crime

The Bridesmaid

Claude Chabrol on 'The Bridesmaid'

Your thrillers are always totally distinctive. How do you explain that?

Generally, in thrillers, it's the plot that keeps things moving. In my films, that's not the case. It's more what we learn about the characters. In the final analysis, the plot is not terribly significant. I try to get it out of the way in the first reel.

Was it a deliberate choice to film a more passionate, sensual story than your more recent movies?

You can't always deal with the same issues. Like it or not, passion expresses itself through sex, for a time at least. We need to show the attraction Philippe feels, 80% of which is down to sex and only 20% the result of the need to fill a yawning gap in his life, an absence of dreams. If the girl had no sex-appeal, it wouldn't work. He'd think it through. In this instance, he puts his mind on hold.

Like your films, Ruth Rendell's novels place more emphasis on psychology than mystery and suspense...

Definitely. She knows what goes through people's minds. At the same time, what's pretty unusual is that she captures the impact of their social background, the way they earn a living, where they live and so on. All that can be totally fascinating, but there are very few thriller writers who are aware of it.

What appeals to you most in the genre?

There has to be a corpse. It grabs people's attention. They like a good corpse. There are some tremendous books where there isn't a corpse, but I always think after the first 50 pages, 'Is this going to interest me?' When I read a book and there's a corpse, I always think that, whatever happens, it won't have been a complete waste of time.

How did you set about adapting the novel?

I worked on the script with Pierre Leccia, who had done an excellent job of adapting another of Ruth Rendell's books. Usually, when I write, I'm the one who keeps the plot nice and tight and I let my co-writers concentrate on the psychological subtleties. In this instance, the plot was already nice and tight so I could just have fun picking up on the little things, which I don't usually get the chance to do.

Did you make any significant changes?

Yes, there was an idea that came to me at the last minute. It was very gratifying because I sent the script to Ruth Rendell and she replied that she was very pleased with it. I hope she wasn't just being polite! She especially liked the idea I had, which was for the Bridesmaid's dress to be cleaned and returned to Senta, who uses it for a purpose I can't tell you about without letting the whole thing out of the bag. But it was a genuinely good idea.

Would you say that killing is the ultimate anarchy?

The trouble is that killing is a bit more serious than anarchy. That's a real problem. There is no more anarchy because it's true that killing someone now is the only means of rebellion but it is an inexcusable rebellion. It would be good for people to rebel more but they need to find other ways.

Sound Effects: Julien Naudin, André Naudin
ADR Recordist: Lionel Le Bras
ADR: Michel Fillipi
Subtitles: Cynthia Schoch, Lenny Borger
Subtitling Paris: Titra Film
Making Of: Pierre-Henri Gibert
Publicity: Eva Simonet
Cast:
Benoît Magimel (*Philippe Tardieu*)
Laura Smet (*Stéphanie 'Senta' Bellange*)
Aurore Clément (*Christine*)
Bernard Le Coq (*Gérard Courtois*)
Solène Bouton (*Sophie Tardieu*)
Anna Mihalcea (*Patricia Tardieu*)
Eric Seigne (*Jacky*)
Pierre-François Duméniaud (*Nadeau*)
Philippe Duclos (*Captain Dutreix*)
Michel Duchaussoy (*the tramp*)
Suzanne Flon (*Mrs Crespin*)
Thomas Chabrol (*Lieutenant José Laval*)
Isolde Barth (*Rita, Senta's mother*)
Chantal Banlier (*grocery shop cashier*)
Jacqueline Cassard (*Madame Bertillon*)
Brigitte Chamarande (*Madame Soupín*)
Emmanuel Faure
Pascal Franks
Pierre Galliard
Florent Gibassier (*pizza server*)
Vincent Guillerminet
Mazen Kiwan (*Pablo*)
Joëlle Legua
Isabelle Leprince (*Madame Pélissier*)
Isabelle Mamère (*Nathalie Dumont*)
Jean-Pierre Niobé
Cécile Peroua
Taieb
Michel Vivier
France-Germany-Italy 2004
110 mins
35mm

The screening on Mon 5 Oct will be introduced by
season curator Catherine Wheatley

With thanks to
Tamasa Distribution

The BFI will be releasing a selection of
Claude Chabrol's films on Blu-ray and DVD in 2027

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You said once that you're not pessimistic about people but about their lives.

Yes, I find that they're sailing by the wrong landmarks. People attach great importance to things that have none or less than they think. I was particularly struck by the onslaught there was recently on happiness. Several books came out proclaiming happiness to be total crap. That made me laugh because you can always find people who think that but they don't all write books at the same time. Anyway, there were debates and discussions and people eventually said, 'Actually, happiness isn't total crap after all.'

Do you think of the audience when you are shooting?

I try not to make things any harder for them. There are some terrifying films, which propose empty or idiotic solutions to people's problems. All the Schwarzenegger-type solutions are bad ones. I'm not talking about Schwarzy the governor but Schwarzy the actor. It's very, very wrong. It leads to guys like Bush, who don't have a single rational thought in their heads. Their thoughts seem rational but they're out of touch with reality.

You never project a particularly attractive image of family life.

The family is one of the biggest frauds ever invented. As much as it is a tremendous concept, when it becomes an obligatory social structure it's atrocious. Right now, things are very interesting because people talk a lot about the breakdown of the nuclear family but instead of using real feelings as a starting point, they use a kind of charter of obligations. The traditional idea of the family is an abomination. The family tree is a monstrous invention. People boasting of one of their ancestors being the Pope's official mustard-supplier! It's pathetic!

You are often compared to Hitchcock. Did you think of Psycho when you were writing the movie?

I can see it now. Depending on people's tastes, it's going to be 'brings to mind *Psycho*' or 'nowhere near as good as *Psycho*'. One or the other.

Does the comparison irritate you?

It doesn't irritate me and it doesn't please me. It's not entirely true, nor is it entirely false, but it's not true in the sense that most people think. There is an inaccurate analysis of the situation. Even so, I prefer people to say that it reminds them of Hitchcock but that it's not as good than for them to say that it reminds them of a film by Alan Smithee.

Production notes